Kennesaw State University 2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog

Courses

Contract All Courses |

Technical Communication

- ### TCOM 2010: Technical Writing

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: ENGL 1102

Description

The course is an introduction to organization, style, and mechanics of technical writing. It includes practice in writing such typical documents as technical descriptions, instructions, proposals, and recommendation reports. Emphasis is placed on incorporating rhetorical theory into planning, organizing, and writing reports; designing visual aids; and editing. Among other assignments, at least one complete technical report is required.

- ### TCOM 2030: Research in Technical Communication

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010

Description

This course is an introduction to research methods used by practitioners and scholars in technical communication. Students explore the relationship between theory and research and learn how to design and carry out empirical studies using both quantitative and qualitative methods. Emphasis is placed on the research methods used in workplace settings to design user-centered information products and to test their usefulness and usability.

- ### TCOM 2050: Issues in Digital Accessibility

3 Credit Hours

Description
This class focuses on disability issues relevant to both the development and use of web and other technologies, mandatory compliance (Section 508) and the ways in which technologies can be made compliant through captioning, proper deployment of HTML code, and more. Students gain an overview of the technological needs and the laws for accommodating persons with disabilities including the assistive technologies available for persons with disabilities (blindness/visual impairments, audiological disabilities, physical disabilities, and cognitive disabilities).

- ## TCOM 3011: Technical Writing II

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010
Description
The course allows students to build on their knowledge of technical writing and explore advanced styles, techniques, and genres used by technical communication practitioners. Topics covered may include writing style in technical communication, and common technical communication genres not covered in TCOM 2010; these genres may include but are not limited to white papers, technical descriptions, technical specifications, professional posters, laboratory reports, and policies and procedures.

- ## TCOM 3030: Instructional Design

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010; non-major: by permission of the Department.
Description
This course introduces and applies systematic instructional design and instructor-led training. Students study a major model of instructional design and apply it to develop and refine a unit of instruction. Students prepare and deliver a training lesson, participate in team instructional design activities, and evaluate the training developed and presented by other students.

- ## TCOM 3046: Information Architecture

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010; Non-majors: by permission of the Department
Description
Students learn about the art and science of structuring information for the web and other devices. This class defines what an information architect (IA) does and what role this individual has as part of a development team. The principles of information architecture are covered, including information-seeking behavior, organizing and labeling models, navigation, search strategies, and other areas critical to a successful architecture. Students learn how to develop wireframe prototypes for testing

and review.

- ## TCOM 3130: Technical Communication: Theory, Ethics, and Practice

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010. Non-major: by permission of the Department.

Description

This course examines a range of theories that have shaped technical communication thought and practice in the twenty-first century. This course also focuses on ethical issues in technical communication through case studies and other readings. This course exposes students to the evolving body of knowledge, including key theorists and practitioners that help form the foundation of the technical communication profession.

- ## TCOM 3245: Search Engine Optimization and Analytics

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010, and TCID 3400. Non-majors: by permission of the Department.

Description

This course introduces students to the concepts, practices, and implementation of Search Engine Optimization (SEO) for digital assets (websites, images, files). Working with an existing website, students enhance existing code to leverage SEO and deploy both analytics and webmaster tools to measure and refine SEO tactics and strategies for maximum SERP presence. This course also covers fundamentals of best practices for Section 508 (ADA) compliance with online documents and website coding.

- ## TCOM 3398: Internship

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: At least 24 hours in the Foundation to Major and Upper Division TCOM/TCID classes, and permission of department.

Description

This course is an opportunity for students to apply principles and techniques of technical communication in a specific organization. Learning is experiential and must supplement, not duplicate, learning in the classroom. The student is responsible for finding an internship, but this program helps in the effort. The student submits a written proposal describing the internship according to program guidelines. Each internship is monitored by the student's advisor.

- ## TCOM 3431: Information Design I

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010, TCID 2002. Non-majors: by permission of the Department

Description

The course introduces students to the principles and best practices of effective information design for both print and electronic media. Students apply rhetorical and gestalt principles to an analysis of information products. Students also redesign products to reflect good principles of information design, and they report on the rationale for these redesigns, showing the ways in which design principles have been effectively applied.

- ## TCOM 4000: Technical Editing

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010. Non-majors: by permission of the Department

Description

This course examines the responsibilities of an editor including the methods and skills needed to edit various types of technical and scientific products (print and digital) with an emphasis on comprehensive editing. The course also teaches students how to prepare content that clearly and effectively communicates technical information to a wide range of end users. This course prepares students for writing and editing careers in technical communication.

- ## TCOM 4045: Multi-Media for Technical Communicators

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010. Non-majors: by permission of the Department

Description

This course is a study of the foundations of multi-media including theory, planning, scripting, storyboarding, and production for technical communicators. Projects in the class include developing multimedia-based process/mechanical descriptions, instructions and interactive graphics for product end users and customers. Students submit research work on the theory of multi-media.

- ## TCOM 4050: Instructional Video

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010. Non-major: by permission of the Department.

Description

This course addresses the theory and practice of developing “how-to” videos for product end users and customers. Fundamentals of instructional design, including audience analysis, goal analysis, formative and summative evaluation, are applied. Contemporary video technologies are used to generate products that instruct and

inform end users/customers. Evaluation of technologies, content transfer, aesthetics and cultural considerations are addressed. Students assess commercially prepared videos and plan for incorporating them in training.

- ## TCOM 4120: Usability

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 2010. Non-major: by permission of the Department.

Description

This course introduces students to UX (User Experience) and usability testing. Included in the course is a review of the relevant research and practical applications of usability testing. Students learn how to develop strategies for planning, conducting, and analyzing a test. In teams, students perform tests using online testing tools, low-fidelity in-person methods, and formal usability lab settings. A final testing report with qualitative and quantitative results is required.

- ## TCOM 4400: Directed Study

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: To be determined by the faculty member teaching the course

Description

This course addresses specific student needs for a specific technical communication topic not covered in the technical communication curriculum.

- ## TCOM 4431: Information Design II

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: TCOM 3431. Non-major: by permission of the Department

Description

Students apply principles and best practices of effective information design in the context of infographics and the visualization of data in analog, print, and digital media. Students create an analog journal of data visualizations and select one visualization of data to illustrate digitally. Additionally, they create graphs and charts in digital documents, produce an information graphic poster, and analyze their effectiveness

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- ## TCOM 4490: Special Topics in Technical Communication

3 Credit Hours

Prerequisite: Approval of the Technical Communication Coordinator and The DWMA Department Chair

Description

This course is used by faculty to offer topics that are relevant to the study of technical communication not currently in the technical communication curriculum.

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